Project 5: The Dialogue of Pessimism

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Wisdom corpus, project 5 (`../corpus.md`; Round 3, run 4 of `../../curated-translation-candidates.md`, 2026-10-21). Read `../../translation-guidelines.md`, `../corpus.md`, `../renderings.md` (**§11 is this run's**), `../translator-brief.md`, then this file.

Scope

The whole text as eBL edits it: **93 labels (1–38, a+1–a+7, 39–86)**, one file `annotated-DP.rtl.md`. Sections: one per exchange (the palace; dining; the open country; the house; silence; fraud; love; sacrifice; lending; the public benefit; "what, then, is good?"), as the frame shows them.

Base edition

- **Rank 1:** eBL `L/2/4`, *Dialogue of Pessimism*, ed. A. A. Fadhil, rev. T. D. N. Mitto, Zs. J. Földi, A. Hätinen, E. Jiménez, G. Rozzi; translation B. R. Foster, E. A. Sarabia, W. Khatabe: `../../sources/eBL/Dialogue-of-Pessimism-SB/reading-edition.md` (93 labels: 1–38, a+1–a+7, 39–86; the notes quote Machinist 2022).
- **Rank 3:** eBL's translation (Foster et al.); Lambert, *Babylonian Wisdom Literature* (1960) is not available here (`../../sources/_records-only--Wisdom-and-righteous-sufferer/`).
- **Line numbering:** eBL's labels.

Why this text (guidelines §1, both purposes)

- **Bible:** Qohelet above all (2:1–11: the experiments with pleasure and work; 1:2; 2:16–17 the skulls of the great and lowly – the same end; 3:19–20; 6:12 7:26 ;מִי יוֹדֵעַ מַה טּוֹב לָאָדָם the woman "more bitter than death, a snare"; 9:2 one fate to the one who sacrifices and the one who does not; 1:4); Job 3 and Jer 20:14–18 (better not to be); Prov 23:27 (the woman a deep pit שׁוּחָה עֲמֻקָּה); lending (Ex 22:24; Prov 22:7); sacrifice and the god trained like a dog (Ps 50:8–13; Isa 1:11; Mal 1); הִנֵּנִי (Gen 22:1, 11; Isa 6:8) for *annû*; "who is so tall as to reach heaven" (Deut 30:12–13; Prov 30:4); the master and slave (Prov 30:22; Qoh 10:7).
- **The ancient mind:** a satire, a dialogue, or a philosophical poem? – the servant's two answers to every wish; the life of a Babylonian gentleman (palace, chariot, dinner, hunting, house, love, sacrifice, lending, public works); "he who eats well is his own god"; the god trained to follow like a dog; Marduk's basket; the ruin-heaps and the skulls; the joke at the end.

Files

`annotated-DP.rtl.md`; `translation--intro-DP.rtl.md` (title and introduction, by the translator); `translation--head.rtl.md` (coordinator); generated `translation-DP.rtl.md`, `translation.rtl.md` (`python3 -I ../wisdom_tools.py build`).

Progress log

- 2026-10-21: base text fetched from eBL; project set up by the run's coordinator; renderings fixed in `../renderings.md` §11.

(The translator appends `## DP` below, with the subsections of `../translator-brief.md` §7.)

DP

Scope

All 93 eBL labels (1–38, a+1–a+7, 39–86) in `annotated-DP.rtl.md`, eleven `##` sections, one per exchange: 1. the palace (1–9), 2. dining (10–16), 3. the open country (17–28), 4. the house (29–38), 5. silence (a+1–a+7), 6. fraud (39–45), 7. love (46–52), 8. sacrifice (53–61), 9. lending (62–69), 10. the public benefit (70–78), 11. "what, then, is good?" (79–86). Preservation: AššNA1 (VAT 9933) carries almost the whole poem; 1–9 and 29–38 are broken at their beginnings; the silence stanza survives only in BabaNB1 (VAT 657), broken at the line ends; BabaNB1 has its own recension in 41, 63–69 (*ipru ana māti* "rations for the land" instead of *ummânu* "capital, loan").

Sources consulted

eBL L/2/4 reading edition (N, T, L, the notes quoting Machinist 2022, the ATF of all six manuscripts), glossary.md, manuscripts.md; the corpus's earlier Hebrew through wisdom_tools.py lemma / grep --gilg (Ludlul, the Theodicy, SH, CW, Gilgameš), kol_tools.py lookup and netherworld_tools.py grep all (all earlier corpora); ETCSL 1.8.1.5 (Gilgameš and Huwawa A 25–33, transliteration and translation, ../../sources/ETCSL/_bulk/.../c.1.8.1.5.xml) for 81–84. No web searches. Lambert 1960 not available (eBL's notes only).

Decisions

- **The frame (renderings §11.4), checked against the transliteration of 1–6 (★): kept as pre-set.** *arad* is the vocative (עָבֶד); *mitanguranni* is *magāru* Gtn imperative + ventive + 1cs, "keep complying with me" – הִתְרַצֶּה לִי (the corpus has *magāru* = רצה: Ludlul I 69, II 33); *annû* is the word *annu* "yes" (eBL lemmatizes it as *annû* I "this": a lemma slip) – הֵן, as Ludlul's *anna*; *ē* "no!" + *ul* + present = לֹא X!, עָבֶד, אני – ... לא (the *-ma* on the object is shown by a dash); *lā* + present (prohibitive) = אַל תX, אדוני!X; the imperative answer X, אדוני, X!. One deviation in form only: the refusal line has a dash after ("לא, עָבֶד, אני – אל ההיכל לא אדהר!") אני, as the Akkadian fronts the emphasized object with *-ma*. Where the infinitive is the object (14 *patānum-ma ul apattan*) the Hebrew has the infinitive absolute (סָעוֹד לא אָסְעַד), as Machinist notes.
- **Vocalization of the frame:** the refrain line "עָבֶד, הִתְרַצֶּה לִי!" "הֵן, אֲדוֹנִי, הֵן!" is vocalized identically in all eleven copies; in the other frame lines only עָבֶד is vocalized (unvocalized it reads "worked"); אדוני plain. Quotation marks mark the change of speaker (they open and close where eBL's T does); the houseless man's speech (34–36) is a quotation inside a quotation (single quotes).
- **The open country (17–28), the inversion word by word:** *muttapraššidu* (man, bird) = נָד (vocalized); *dayyālu* (dog) = סובב (*dâlu* = סובב, Gilgameš); *murtappidu* (wild ass) = משוטט (*rapādu*, Gilgameš); *akkannu* = 28–25 .ערוד repeat the four subjects of 19–22 in the same Hebrew (הערוד המשוטט, **העורב** הנָּד, הכלב הסובב, האדם הנָּד). נודד was not available (SH 67 *ṣā'idu*); the Gilgameš ban on נָד concerns *rapādu*, not *muttapraššidu* "fugitive".

- **New words fixed here** (all grepped first): *mašāru* (drive a chariot) דהר (נהג is *warû*, CW; רכב *rakābu*, Gilgameš); *dekû* "raise, fetch" הרם (הביא *wabālu*, הגיש *ṭeḫû*; Ludlul's העיר is the sense "rouse"); *šīšir* לַךְ יָשָׁר (keeps *ešēru* = ישר); *patānu* / *patnu* סעודה / סעד (collision, see open decisions); *ḫaḫḫūru* **עורב** (italic, open); *qinnu* / *qanānu* קנן / קן (Gilgameš); *nawû* נווה [cognate], *narbāṣu* מרבץ [cognate]; *samītu* (החומה) תחתית; *qayyalu* קשוב; *šinipu* שני שלישים; *qâdu* הצית, *kâšu* I "linger" התמהמה; *bēl dabābi* בעל־דברים (the idiom of Ex 24:14, chosen as a unit); *sakātu* שתק; *pâ epēšu* פתח את הפה (Gilgameš's speech formula); *sartu* מרמה (lemma **'sartu'**: no earlier rendering in the corpus; *sarrātu* "lies" stays כזבים); *kâṣu* מופשט־עור; *napālu* D (eyes) ניקר; *qūlu* דּוּמִיָּה; *ḫirītu* חפירה (*ḫerû* = חפר, Gilgameš); *šēlu* מושחז; *qīptu* "credit" פיקדון (Ludlul I 61's פקודה is the sense "office": one Hebrew root, two nouns by sense); *ummânu* "capital, loan" מַשָּׂאָה (always vocalized; same root as SH 118's נושה for *ummânu* "creditor"); *ḫalāpu* Gt (clothes) התעטף (Ludlul's מכורבל by sense); *qappatu* סלסלה (סל is *pisannu*, Ludlul III 104; קופה *quppu*; טנא rejected: Deut 26); *labīru* עתיק; *arkû* / *pānû* (pl.) ראשונים / אחרונים; *tikku* מפרקת (a deviation from Gilgameš עורף, which this corpus has for *labānu*, Ludlul II 61); *nasāku* זרק (Gilgameš, Etana; השליך is *nadû*); *gamāru* D "encompass" הקיף (by sense; גמר elsewhere, 3 Š הגמיר); *Latarak* לָטַרָךְ; *lū* (86) לוּ [cognate].
- **Copied from the finished texts of this run:** *usātu* עזרה, *bēl usāti* / *bēl lemutti* בעל עזרה / בעל רעה (SH 122, CW A+16); *niqû* זבח; *lillu* כסיל; *šuttatu* שוחה (CW 39, Etana); *būrtu* (11.8§) בור; *uṭṭatu* גרגיר (CW A+83); *ḫubullu* חוב; *rubû* נשיא (SH); *nadānu* נתן; *ḫalāqu* D איבד (SH 104); *pāna wabālu* (11.10§) נשא פנים; *erēšu* שאל (CW A+13).
- **Parenthesized words of N** (*umma*, *(kīmi)* in 47, 71, *(u)* in 22, *(ša)* in 41) are not translated (§10.1). *kīmi* is אם כך in the answers (40, 63) and [לאמור] in 36 (introducing a quotation).
- **Brackets** follow the ATF of all manuscripts, so they sometimes differ from N's: 63 *[idin]*, 65, 66 are preserved in BabaNB1 / AššNA1 and are not bracketed.
- **No ⟨⟩ line for 43:** eBL's T adds "<Do not do it master, do not do it>" – the servant's prohibitive line is missing in every manuscript; the Hebrew adds nothing and the note says so.

Open decisions for the user

1. ***patānu* "dine" = סעד** collides with Ludlul I 10, 12 (*kâšu* D "sustain" = סועד). Alternatives: לחם (לְלָחוֹם אֶת-מוֹשֶׁל, Prov 23:1 – the exact situation, but unvocalized it reads "fight"); אכל ארוחה (two words in a refrain; *akālu* = אכל is in 16). Kept סעד.
2. ***ḫaḫḫūru* = עורב** (italic): eBL's lemma "raven", Machinist "hunting falcon", eBL's T "bird". עורב is the flood corpus's word for *āribu* (Gen 8:7), so two Akkadian words share it; alternatives: transliterate חַחוּרוּ, or a hawk word (נֵץ).
3. ***ummânu* "loan" = מַשָּׂאָה** against §11.2's *ummânu* = נושה (the creditor): the sense here is the money given (object of *nadānu*). Same root kept.
4. ***tikku* = מפרקת** (a deviation from Gilgameš עורף): this corpus has עורף for *labānu*.

5. ***muttapraššidu* = נָד**: if the user prefers to keep נודד / נד away from every Cain echo (as Gilgameš does for *rapādu*), the alternative is הנמלט (but נמלט is the law corpus's *ḫalāqu* "flee").
6. **77 *arkûti u pānûti*:** rendered literally אחרונים ... ראשונים (later / earlier), which keeps both readings (generations; low / high rank) and shows Qoh 1:11; eBL's "the lowly and great" chooses the second.
7. **13 *šēbi patni ilšu*:** three readings (eBL "he who eats well is his own god"; Machinist "who is sated with the meal of his god"; Mitto "his god too is sated"); the Hebrew follows eBL with (הוא) added.

Progress log

- 2026-10-22: drafted all 93 labels section by section (each section written to disk at once, as instructed), source lines as @ + wisdom_tools.py fill DP.
- Pass (a) fidelity: every content word checked against N and the ATF; brackets re-checked against all manuscripts (63, 65, 66 unbracketed; 14 [עָבֶ]ד); additions only in ( ) (13 (הוא), 16 41 , (זה) / a+6 (אם)); 43's missing prohibitive line not supplied.
- Pass (b) consistency: the frame identical in every copy (verify: no difference inside DP except eBL's false link 6 ↔ 23 – line 6's Parallels: field names 23, the refusal line; the real parallel is 24, which is identical); 2 = 18 = (11, 54) where the Akkadian is identical; 59 = 75; 6 = 24; the four subjects of 19–22 = 25–28; 47 אֲהַב vocalized in both halves; every new word grepped against the corpus, Gilgameš and the other corpora (collisions recorded above).
- Pass (c) Hebrew: read the generated translation-DP.rtl.md; fixed the intro's paraphrases to quote the translation itself.
- check_bible_quotes.py on the annotated file, the intro, the generated translation and this file: 0 problems (one Psalms quotation and one Lev quotation corrected; every quotation has its reference in parentheses). wisdom_tools.py build run; verify DP --strict: 0 problems (one reported repeated-line difference = eBL's false link 6 ↔ 23).
- Tool note: pars DP reads the chapter-less links now (the coordinator's fix); the remaining report 6 ≠ 23 is eBL's error, not the tool's.

Parallels index (DP)

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
1 etc.	*annû bēlī annû*	הֵן, אֲדוֹנִי, הֵן!	וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו אַבְרָהָם וַיֹּאמֶר הִנֵּנִי (בראשית כב:א); וָאֹמַר הִנֵּנִי שְׁלָחֵנִי (ישעיהו ו:ח)	[equivalent]	Machinist: *annu* is "here I am, ready", best matched by הִנֵּנִי. The Akkadian word is "yes" (*annu*), not a deictic + pronoun: הנני kept out of the Hebrew (reserved). The servant's total readiness is the joke; Abraham's is the test.
4	*[…] ubbala pānīka*	[…] ישא את פניך	הִנֵּה נָשָׂאתִי פָנֶיךָ גַּם לַדָּבָר הַזֶּה (בראשית יט:כא); כִּי אִם פָּנָיו אָשָׂא (איוב מב:ח)	[equivalent]	*pāna wabālu* = "lift the face" = show favour (the idiom licensed in §11.10). Subject restored ("the prince", Machinist).
8	*[gerra? ša l]ā tīdû ušaṣbatka*	[מסילה?] א[אשר ל]א ידעת – יאחיזך	וְיֹאחֲז צַדִּיק דַּרְכּוֹ (איוב יז:ט)	[equivalent]	"Seizing a road" (*ṣabātu* / אחז); the noun restored. = Gilgameš III 27, 50 (*gerra ša lā īdû*).
12	*sāḫiru patāni pēti libbi*	החוזר אל הסעודה – פותח לב	סְעָד לִבְּךָ פַּת לֶחֶם (שופטים יט:ה); וְלֶחֶם לְבַב-אֱנוֹשׁ יִסְעָד (תהלים קד:טו)	[equivalent]	Food and the heart; the verbal link סעד is the Hebrew's (patānu is not its cognate), the Akkadian "opens" the heart.

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
12	*sāḫiru patāni*	החוזר אל הסעודה	וַאֲרֻחָתוֹ אֲרֻחַת תָּמִיד נִתְּנָה לוֹ מֵאֵת הַמֶּלֶךְ (מלכים ב כה:ל)	[equivalent]	The regular meal as a mark of standing (eBL "regular dining").
13	*šēbi patni ilšu*	השבע – סעודה (הוא) אֵלוֹ	אֵין טוֹב בָּאָדָם שֶׁיֹּאכַל וְשָׁתָה ... כִּי מִיַּד הָאֱלֹהִים הִיא (קהלת ב:כד)	[divergence]	Qohelet: eating is God's gift; here the sated man "is his own god" (eBL reading; two others in the note).
13	*itti qātī mesâti illak šamaš*	עם ידיים רחוצות הולך שמש	אָרְחַץ בְּנִקָּיוֹן כַּפָּי; וַאֲסֹבְבָה אֶת-מִזְבַּחֲךָ יְהוָה (תהלים כו:ו)	[divergence]	Washed hands and the god's presence; in the Psalm a sign of innocence at the altar, here a table rite. Hand-washing before meals is [absent] from the Torah.
14	*patānum-ma ul apattan*	סָעוּד לא אֶסְעַד	מוֹת תָּמוּת (בראשית ב:יז)	[equivalent]	Grammar only: infinitive + finite verb for emphasis = the Hebrew infinitive absolute (Machinist).
16	*burrû akālu ṣummû šatû*	לרעוב – ולאכול, לצמוא – ולשתות	וְשָׂרַיִךְ בָּעֵת יֹאכֵלוּ (קהלת י:יז); לֵךְ אֱכֹל בְּשִׂמְחָה לַחְמֶךָ (קהלת ט:ז)	[equivalent] / [divergence]	Eating in its time (Qoh 10:17); Qoh 9:7 recommends eating, as the servant's *positive* answer does.

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
19, 21, 25, 27	*amēlu muttapraššidu*, *ḫaḫḫūru muttapraššidu*, *qinnu*	האדם הנָּד, העורב הנָּד, יקנן קן	כְּצִפּוֹר נוֹדֶדֶת מִן-קִנָּהּ; כֵּן-אִישׁ נוֹדֵד מִמְּקוֹמוֹ (משלי כז:ח)	[equivalent]	**One adjective for the roaming man and the roaming bird, with the nest – as in Prov 27:8.** In Proverbs the wanderer is a disaster; the servant makes him first happy (19–22), then wretched (25–28).
19	*muttapraššidu*	הנָּד	נָע וָנָד תִּהְיֶה בָּאָרֶץ (בראשית ד:יב)	[equivalent]	The homeless fugitive; נָד chosen by meaning ("fugitive, homeless"), see open decision 5.
20, 26	*kalbu dayyālu*	הכלב הסובב	יֶהֱמוּ כַכֶּלֶב; וְיסֹבְבוּ עִיר (תהלים נט:ז)	[equivalent]	*dayyālu* < *dâlu* = סובב (Gilgameš): the dogs that go round the city.
21	*iqannun qinna*	יקנן קן	שָׂמָה קִנְּנָה קְפוֹז (ישעיהו לד:טו)	[cognate]	*qanānu qinna* = קנן קן, the same figura etymologica.
21, 27	*qinnu*; *bīssu*	קן; ביתו	גַּם-צִפּוֹר מָצְאָה בַיִת וּדְרוֹר קֵן לָהּ (תהלים פד:ד)	[divergence]	The bird's nest and "house": in the Psalm by God's altars, in 27 a hole in the wall.

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
22, 28	*akkannu murtappidu*; *namû narbāssu*	הערוד המשוטט; הנווה מרבצו	אֲשֶׁר-שַׂמְתִּי עֲרָבָה בֵּיתוֹ; וּמִשְׁכְּנוֹתָיו מְלֵחָה (איוב לט:ו); יִתּוּר הָרִים מִרְעֵהוּ (איוב לט:ח); וּמוֹסְרוֹת עָרוֹד מִי פִּתֵּחַ (איוב לט:ה)	[equivalent]	**The same animal (*akkannu* = עָרוֹד) whose home is the steppe and who roams for pasture.** *nawû* ~ נָוֶה, *narbāṣu* ~ מַרְבֵּץ [cognate].
25	*ṭēnšu uštannīšu*	דעתו נשתנתה עליו	וַיְשַׁנּוֹ אֶת טַעְמוֹ בְּעֵינֵיהֶם וַיִּתְהֹלֵל בְּיָדָם (שמואל א כא:יד)	[equivalent]	"His judgement changed" = madness: *ṭēmu* + *šanû* ~ + טַעַם שנה (both cognate in this sense).
26	*išabbirū šinnūšu*	ישברו שיניו	שְׁנֵי רְשָׁעִים שִׁבַּרְתָּ (תהלים ג:ח)	[cognate] / [divergence]	*šebēru* = שבר; in the Psalm God breaks the teeth, here the dog breaks its own on the bone.
32	*daltu? petītu šumšu*	דלת? – פתוחה שמו	טוֹב שֵׁם מִשֶּׁמֶן טוֹב (קהלת ז:א)	[equivalent]	The good name as an asset; reading uncertain.
35	*bēl dabābīya*	בעל־דברי	מִי בַעַל דְּבָרִים יִגַּשׁ אֲלֵהֶם (שמות כד:יד)	[equivalent]	"Lord of the talk" = the opponent at law; the Hebrew idiom chosen as a unit.

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
38	*bīt abīšu iḫtepi*	את בית אביו בקע	וְכֹל בֵּית יוֹסֵף וְאָחָיו וּבֵית אָבִיו (בראשית נ:ח)	[equivalent]	The father's house as the inherited household.
a+3	*sukut bēlī sukut*	שתוק, אדוני, שתוק!	גַּם אֱוִיל מַחֲרִישׁ חָכָם יֵחָשֵׁב (משלי יז:כח); עֵת לַחֲשׁוֹת וְעֵת לְדַבֵּר (קהלת ג:ז)	[equivalent]	Silence as wisdom – and (a+6–a+7) as danger in court.
a+6	*pīka ul teppuš*	את פיך לא תפתח	פְּתַח-פִּיךָ לְאִלֵּם; אֶל-דִּין כָּל-בְּנֵי חֲלוֹף (משלי לא:ח)	[equivalent]	Opening the mouth in a lawsuit.
a+7	*bēlū dīnīka uzzazū ina muḫḫīka*	בעלי דינך יעמדו עליך	וְהַשָּׂטָן עֹמֵד עַל יְמִינוֹ לְשִׂטְנוֹ (זכריה ג:א)	[divergence]	The adversary at law "stands over" the accused; human litigants here, שטן never in the Hebrew.
40	*sarta lūpuš*	מרמה אעשה	מֹאזְנֵי מִרְמָה תּוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה (משלי יא:א)	[equivalent] / [divergence]	*sartu* = (11.2§) מרמה. Proverbs: an abomination; the servant: the only way to get clothes and food.

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
44	*šumma kīṣ*	אם מופשט־עור	וְהִפְשִׁיט אֶת הָעֹלָה (ויקרא א:ו)	[divergence] / [absent]	Flaying is of the sacrifice only in the Bible; as a punishment of men it is [absent] (an Assyrian punishment of rebels).
45	*nuppul … ṣabit … ina bīt killi nadi*	מנוקר־עיניים … אחוז … בבית כלא מושלך	וַיֹּאחֲזוּהוּ פְּלִשְׁתִּים וַיְנַקְּרוּ אֶת עֵינָיו (שופטים טז:כא); כִּי אֹתוֹ עָשׂוּ לְבֵית הַכֶּלֶא (ירמיהו לז:טו)	[equivalent]	**The same sequence as Samson's: seized, blinded, prison.** *bīt kīli* = בֵּית הַכֶּלֶא (*kīlu* ~ כלא [cognate]).
48	*qūla u nissata imêš*	דומייה ויגון בוזה	וְלַיְלָה וְלֹא-דֻמִיָּה לִי (תהלים כב:ג)	[equivalent]	*qūlu* = the numb silence of despair; BabaNB1 *kūru u nissatu* = the Theodicy's (30) pair כהות ויגון.
51	*sinništu būrtu būrtu šuttatu ḫirītu*	אישה – בור, בור, שוחה, חפירה	כִּי-שׁוּחָה עָמֻקָּה זוֹנָה; וּבְאֵר צָרָה נָכְרִיָּה (משלי כג:כז)	[equivalent] / [cognate]	**Both pit-words of the line in one verse**: *šuttatu* = שׁוּחָה, *būrtu* ~ בְּאֵר / בּוֹר [cognate]. Proverbs: the harlot, the foreign woman; here every woman.
51	*šuttatu*	שוחה	שׁוּחָה עֲמֻקָּה פִּי זָרוֹת (משלי כב:יד)	[equivalent]	As CW 39.

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
51	*sinništu … šuttatu*	… – אישה שוחה	וּמוֹצֵא אֲנִי מַר מִמָּוֶת אֶת הָאִשָּׁה אֲשֶׁר הִיא מְצוֹדִים וַחֲרָמִים לִבָּהּ (קהלת ז:כו)	[equivalent]	The woman as a hunter's trap.
52	*patar parzilli šēlu ša ikkisu kišād eṭli*	סכין ברזל מושחזת, אשר כורתת צוואר עלם	וְאַחֲרִיתָהּ מָרָה כַלַּעֲנָה; חַדָּה כְּחֶרֶב פִּיּוֹת (משלי ה:ד)	[equivalent]	**The woman as a sharp blade**; *parzillu* ~ בַּרְזֶל [cognate].
55	*niqâ lūpuš*	זבח אעשה	וַיָּבֹאוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת זְבָחִים וְעֹלוֹת (מלכים ב י:כד)	[equivalent]	*niqâ epēšu* = עשה זבח, the same idiom.
56	*libbašu ṭābšu*	לבו טוב לו	וּשְׁתֵה בְלֵב טוֹב יֵינֶךָ (קהלת ט:ז)	[cognate]	*ṭābu* = טוב; contentment. eBL's "satisfying transaction" reads 57 into 56.
57	*qīpta eli qīpti ippuš*	פיקדון על פיקדון עושה	מַלְוֵה יְהוָה חוֹנֵן דָּל; וּגְמֻלוֹ יְשַׁלֶּם-לוֹ (משלי יט:יז)	[equivalent] / [divergence]	**Piety as a loan to the god.** In Proverbs the loan is charity to the poor; here the sacrifice itself. פִּקָּדוֹן (ויקרא ה:כא) for *qīptu*.

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
60	*ila tulammassū-ma kī kalbi arkīka ittanallak*	את האל – תלמדנו, וככלב אחריך יתהלך	לֹא-אֶקַּח מִבֵּיתְךָ פָּר ... אִם-אֶרְעֶב לֹא-אֹמַר לָךְ (תהלים נ:ט, יב); לָמָּה לִּי רֹב זִבְחֵיכֶם יֹאמַר יְהוָה (ישעיהו א:יא); וּמִנְחָה לֹא אֶרְצֶה מִיָּדְכֶם (מלאכי א:י)	[divergence]	**The opposite critique**: the Bible's God needs no sacrifices; the servant's god is made dependent on them, like a dog trained to follow for food. *lamādu* D ~ לָמַד [cognate].
63	*ummâna luddin*	מַשָּׁאָה אתן	כִּי תַשֶּׁה בְרֵעֲךָ מַשַּׁאת מְאוּמָה (דברים כד:י); אִם כֶּסֶף תַּלְוֶה אֶת עַמִּי ... לֹא תִהְיֶה לוֹ כְּנֹשֶׁה (שמות כב:כד)	[equivalent]	Lending; נושה / מַשָּׁאָה is one Hebrew root for the one Akkadian word (loan / creditor).
64	*ḫubullašu atru*	וחובו – יתיר	לֹא תְשִׂימוּן עָלָיו נֶשֶׁךְ (שמות כב:כד)	[divergence]	The Torah forbids interest from the poor; the servant praises it as pure profit. רבית / נשך kept out of the Hebrew.

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
67	*turru kīma alādi maruṣ*	וההשבה – כלידה, נַחְלָה	בְּעֶצֶב תֵּלְדִי בָנִים (בראשית ג:טז); צָרָה הָחֱזַקְתְּנוּ חִיל כַּיּוֹלֵדָה (ירמיהו ו:כד); נַחְלָה מַכָּתִי (ירמיהו י:יט)	[equivalent]	Childbirth as the paradigm of pain; *marāṣu* ~ נִמְרֶצֶת [cognate]; נַחְלָה "grievous".
67–69	*nadānu … turru*	הנתינה … וההשבה	וְעֶבֶד לֹוֶה לְאִישׁ מַלְוֶה (משלי כב:ז)	[divergence]	In Proverbs the borrower is the slave; here the lender suffers (his grain eaten, cursed, his interest lost).
71	*usāta ana mātīya*	עזרה לארצי	עֶזְרָה בְצָרוֹת נִמְצָא מְאֹד (תהלים מו:ב)	[divergence]	Biblical עֶזְרָה is God's help; *usātu* is a man's good deed for the land (§11.4).
73	*šaknā usātūšu ina qappati ša marūtuk*	שׂוּמוֹת עזרותיו בסלסלה של מרדוך	שִׂימָה דִמְעָתִי בְנֹאדֶךָ; הֲלֹא בְּסִפְרָתֶךָ (תהלים נו:ט)	[equivalent]	**The god stores a man's deeds in his own vessel** (Marduk's basket / God's flask), with the same verb (*šakānu* / שִׂים [cognate]).
76	*elī-ma ina muḫḫi tīlānī labīrūti atallak*	עלה על התלים העתיקים והתהלך	וְהָיְתָה לְתֵל שְׁמָמָה (ירמיהו מט:ב)	[cognate]	*tīlu* = תֵּל. The line quotes Gilgameš I 18 / XI 323 ("go up on the wall of Uruk and walk around") and inverts it: ruins, not a lasting work (George 2003: 526).

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
77	*gulgullī ša arkûti u pānûti*	גולגלות של אחרונים ושל ראשונים	אֵין זִכְרוֹן לָרִאשֹׁנִים; וְגַם לָאַחֲרֹנִים שֶׁיִּהְיוּ לֹא יִהְיֶה לָהֶם זִכָּרוֹן (קהלת א:יא)	[equivalent]	**The same pair of words, later / earlier, and the same conclusion.** Finding: eBL's T "the lowly and great" hides it (eBL's own lemmas: *arkû* "later", *pānû* "earlier"). *gulgullu* ~ גֻּלְגֹּלֶת [cognate].
77	*gulgullī ša arkûti u pānûti*	גולגלות של אחרונים ושל ראשונים	וְאֵיךְ יָמוּת הֶחָכָם עִם הַכְּסִיל (קהלת ב:טז)	[equivalent]	One death for all.
78	*ayyu bēl lemutti … ayyu bēl usāti*	איזהו בעל רעה – ואיזהו בעל עזרה?	מִקְרֶה אֶחָד לַצַּדִּיק וְלָרָשָׁע לַטּוֹב וְלַזַּבֵּחַ … וְלַאֲשֶׁר אֵינֶנּוּ זֹבֵחַ (קהלת ט:ב)	[equivalent]	**One fate to the doer of good and of evil, to the one who sacrifices and the one who does not**: Qoh 9:2 joins the poem's two religious stanzas (sacrifice, the public benefit).
78	*ayyu bēl lemutti*	איזהו בעל רעה	כִּי מִקְרֶה בְנֵי הָאָדָם וּמִקְרֶה הַבְּהֵמָה וּמִקְרֶה אֶחָד לָהֶם (קהלת ג:יט)	[equivalent]	

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
80	*enenna mīnû ṭāb*	עַתָּה, מַה טּוֹב?	כִּי מִי יוֹדֵעַ מַה טּוֹב לָאָדָם בַּחַיִּים (קהלת ו:יב)	[cognate] / [divergence]	מַה טּוֹב = *mīnû ṭāb* (*ṭābu* ~ טוֹב). Qohelet: nobody knows; the servant answers at once.
80	*mīnû ṭāb*	מה טוב?	לְכָה נָּא אֲנַסְּכָה בְשִׂמְחָה וּרְאֵה בְטוֹב (קהלת ב:א)	[equivalent]	Testing every way of life for "the good" – Qohelet's experiment, the master's sequence.
81	*tikkī tikkaka šebēru*	את מפרקתי ואת מפרקתך – לשבור	וַתִּשָּׁבֵר מַפְרַקְתּוֹ וַיָּמֹת (שמואל א ד:יח)	[equivalent]	Breaking the neck = death; *šebēru* ~ שבר [cognate].
81–82	*šebēru … ana nāri našāku ṭāb*	לשבור … ואל הנהר לזרוק – טוב	וְשַׁבֵּחַ אֲנִי אֶת הַמֵּתִים שֶׁכְּבָר מֵתוּ מִן הַחַיִּים (קהלת ד:ב); יֹאבַד יוֹם אִוָּלֵד בּוֹ (איוב ג:ג); אָרוּר הַיּוֹם אֲשֶׁר יֻלַּדְתִּי בּוֹ (ירמיהו כ:יד)	[equivalent]	Death as "the good"; in Qohelet a reflection, in Job and Jeremiah a curse of birth, here a practical proposal (for two).

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
82	*ana nāri našāku*	אל הנהר לזרוק	שָׂאוּנִי וַהֲטִילֻנִי אֶל הַיָּם (יונה א:יב); כָּל הַבֵּן הַיִּלּוֹד הַיְאֹרָה תַּשְׁלִיכֻהוּ (שמות א:כב)	[equivalent] / [divergence]	Throwing into the water as chosen death (Jonah, to save others). The river is also the ordeal god (LH §2).
83	*ayyu arku ša ana šamê elû*	איזהו ארוך – אשר אל השמים יעלה?	מִי יַעֲלֶה לָּנוּ הַשָּׁמַיְמָה (דברים ל:יב); מִי עָלָה-שָׁמַיִם וַיֵּרַד (משלי ל:ד)	[equivalent] / [divergence]	The same rhetorical question with the same verb (*elû* / עלה). Deut 30: so the commandment is near; here: so one may as well die.
83–84	*ayyu arku … ayyu rapšu*	איזהו ארוך … איזהו רחב	אָרְכָּהּ מֵאֶרֶץ מִדָּהּ; וּרְחָבָה מִנִּי-יָם (איוב יא:ט); גָּבְהֵי שָׁמַיִם מַה-תִּפְעָל; עֲמֻקָּה מִשְּׁאוֹל מַה-תֵּדָע (איוב יא:ח)	[cognate] / [equivalent]	**The same pair of adjectives, long and broad** (*arku* ~ אָרֹךְ [cognate]), with heaven and the depths as the limits man cannot reach (in Job: God's wisdom). Source of the saying: Gilgameš and Huwawa A 28–29 (ETCSL 1.8.1.5), with the neck, the wall and the corpses in the river beside it (A 25–26); Gilgameš OB III 140–142 "who, my friend, can go up to heaven?".

Line	Akkadian	Hebrew rendering	Bible	Tag	Comment
84	*ša erṣeta ugammeru*	אשר את הארץ יקיף	וְלֹא מֵעֲבָר לַיָּם הִוא (דברים ל:יג)	[equivalent]	The second half of the same pair of questions. *erṣetu* = earth / netherworld (הארץ, never שאול).
86	*u bēlī lū šalāš ūmī kī arkīya iballuṭ*	ואדוני – לו שלושה ימים אחריי יחיה!	אֲשֶׁר מִי יַגִּיד לָאָדָם מַה יִּהְיֶה אַחֲרָיו תַּחַת הַשָּׁמֶשׁ (קהלת ו:יב)	[divergence]	Qohelet asks what will be "after" a man; the servant knows what will be after him. *lū* ~ לו [cognate].
(whole)	the master and the servant	עבד / אדון	תַּחַת-עָבֶד כִּי יִמְלוֹךְ (משלי ל:כב); רָאִיתִי עֲבָדִים עַל סוּסִים; וְשָׂרִים הֹלְכִים כַּעֲבָדִים עַל הָאָרֶץ (קהלת י:ז)	[divergence]	The world upside down: in the Bible a misfortune; in the poem the servant is the wiser of the two and the master cannot live without him (86).

The text on its own terms

- **The gentleman's life** (all stanzas): chariot and palace (2–9), the regular dinner with hand-washing (11–13), hunting in the steppe with a bird (18–22), building a house and keeping the father's household (30–38), the lawcourt (a+6–a+7, 35), love (47–52), sacrifice to the personal god (54–61), lending barley at interest (63–69), public works "for the land" (71–73): an inventory of what an urban Babylonian of standing did and valued.
- **The court is grace and danger at once** (3–9): the prince "lifts your face", and the same prince sends you on campaign by a road you do not know (8 = a stock phrase: Gilgameš III, a Nimrud proverb tablet).
- **Šamaš at the table** (13): the god of justice "goes with" washed hands; and in the same line the sated man is "his own god" – the personal god of Ludlul and the Theodicy reduced to a full stomach.

- **The steppe** (17–28): man, dog, bird and wild ass are each free and fed – and each mad, toothless, homeless, condemned to the open; the same facts, two speeches. The city-dweller's view of nomads: the roamer's "judgement changes" (25).
- **The houseless man** (33–36) is "two-thirds a fool" – a parody of Gilgameš's "two-thirds god" – and pleads with his creditor in the servant's own formula ("Look, master, look!").
- **Silence** (a+1–a+7): the wisdom virtue of the closed mouth (cf. CW) against the court's reality – who does not speak loses.
- **Crime and punishment** (44–45): death, flaying, blinding, arrest, prison – the Assyrian state's range of punishments, given as a practical, not a moral, argument.
- **Love** (48–52): one of the few Akkadian lines on love as the cure for grief (*qūlu u nissatu*), set beside the stock misogyny of wisdom literature (pit, trap, iron dagger).
- **Religion as commerce** (56–61): sacrifice is credit (*qīptu*) stored with the god; and the god, fed, is trained "like a dog" to follow and to demand rites and Latarak figurines (apotropaic statuettes buried in houses). Both answers assume the same contract.
- **Lending** (63–69): grain loans at interest (barley, ŠE.BAR), the lender's dream of capital that stays while interest grows, and his nightmare of debtors who eat the grain and curse him. "Lending is like love, getting back is like childbirth" is a proverb of the marketplace.
- **Marduk's basket** (73): good deeds are "placed" in the god's palm-leaf basket – stored, it seems, like produce or a deposit; the servant then shows the skulls on the ruin-heaps that cannot tell good from evil (76–78).
- **The literary self-awareness**: 76 quotes the end of Gilgameš ("go up on the wall … and walk around") and 83–84 the saying from Gilgameš and Huwawa; the poem answers the heroic tradition's "therefore let me make a name" with "therefore it is good to die".
- **The servant's two answers to every wish** are the poem's form and its philosophy: every act has a good and a bad description, and speech can always supply both. Whether this is satire (a foolish master, a servile slave who in the end is the only one who knows the master cannot survive without him) or a philosophical poem on the emptiness of all action – the ending (85–86) keeps both open.
- **Scribal touches**: BabaNB1 writes "my lord" with the sign group of the god Bēl ({d}+EN); AššNA1 writes *inanna* "now" with the divine determinative (*i-{d}nanna*); the repeated word written MIN ("ditto") in a+3, 51, 66.

Lines shared with other files

- Inside DP: the refrain (1, 10, 17, 29, a+1, 39, 46, 53, 62, 70, 79) identical; 2 ≈ 18 (place changed), 11 ≈ 54 (the end changed: `ואסעד` / continued in 55); 6 = 24; 59 = 75; the refusal lines share `"לא … – אני, עֶבֶד, לא X!"`; 19–22 / 25–28 share their subjects.
- With Gilgameš: 8 ↔ III 27, 50 (`מסילה אשר לא ידע…`); 76 ↔ I 18, XI 323 (`עלה על … והתהלך`, the structure copied); 33 ↔ I 48 (`שני שלישיו`, our link); 83 ↔ OB III 140.
- With SH / CW: *usātu*, *bēl usāti* (SH 122, CW A+16), *šuttatu* (CW 39), *lillu* (CW 7), *uṭṭatu* (CW A+83), *ummânu* "creditor" (SH 118, by root), *ḫalāqu* D (SH 104) – all copied.

- With the Theodicy: 48 BabaNB1 *kūru u nissatu* = Th 30 כהות ויגון (noted, not in the Hebrew: the main text has *qūlu*).

Proposals for the shared renderings

- §11.4, the frame as drafted: refusal "אני, לא, עָבָד – <object> לא <verb>!" (with the dash); the refrain vocalized identically every time; עָבָד always vocalized in the frame.
- *mašāru* דהר; *dekû* "fetch, raise" הרם (beside Ludlul's העיר "rouse"); *patānu* / *patnu* / סעד סעודה (open: collision with *kâšu* D); *muttapraššidu* נָד (vocalized); *dayyālu* סובב; *ḫaḫḫūru* עורב (open); *nawû* נווה [cognate], *narbāṣu* מרבץ [cognate]; *qayyalu* קשוב; *bēl dabābi* בעל־דברים; *sakātu* שתק; *kâṣu* מופשט־עור; *napālu* D (eyes) ניקר; *qūlu* דומייה; *ḫirītu* חפירה; *qīptu* "credit" פיקדון; *ummânu* "capital, loan" מַשָּׂאָה (vocalized); *qappatu* סלסלה; *tīlu* תל, *gulgullu* גולגולת [cognates]; *labīru* עתיק; *tikku* מפרקת; *nasāku* זרק (as Gilgameš / Etana); *Latarak* לָטָרָךְ.
- Always vocalize (add to §8): מַשָּׂאָה, נָד, נַחְלָה (stative "grievous"; unvocalized "inheritance"), אֵלּוּ (already), עָבָד in dialogue frames.

Lessons for the guidelines

- **A modern translation's social gloss can hide a lexical parallel**: eBL's "the lowly and great" (77) for *arkûti u pānûti* "the later and the earlier" hides Qoh 1:11's רִאשֹׁנִים ... אַחֲרֹנִים. Check pairs of adjectives against the lemmas, not the English.
- **Look for the Sumerian source of an Akkadian saying in ETCSL** (the bulk zip is local): DP 83–84 is Gilgameš and Huwawa A 28–29, and the neighbouring lines there (neck, wall, corpses in the river) explain the sequence of DP 76–84.
- **eBL's Parallels: field links a line to a non-parallel one** (DP 6 → 23 instead of 24): such reported differences are justified in the apparatus, not "fixed".